

packs that go on sale frequently at my grocer. Individually wrapped portions keep us in line by making sure we don't overindulge in cookies, crackers, or chips. Seriously, folks, who are we kidding? If you look at how much they are charging per portion, it is insanely overpriced. I could easily dole out 13 crackers at an equal 100 calories on my own and toss them in a reusable plastic baggie, thus saving money and the damage to the environment. *What about the health benefits of watching your portions?* If your penchant to overeat is so easily restrained by the workings of a flimsy cellophane bag marked "100 calories," then you are a better person than I am.

2. Soup causes

Any company that works alongside an honorable charity has my full support. However, I would like to clarify that I have been disappointed in the rash of breast cancer promotions by my favorite brands. Pink soup cans, pink appliances, and pink candies have me a little overwhelmed and confused. Are we expected to pay more for these premium brands simply because of a promise that a tiny percentage of the purchase price will go to breast cancer research? Personally, I would rather use a coupon or buy the store-brand mushroom soup, and write out a nice

\$15 check to the charity of my choice. I get more groceries for my money, and it's tax deductible. By exploiting a "relationship" with the Susan G. Komen fund, many companies have managed to sell plenty of stale merchandise at quite a premium. For more information on how companies are profiting from these campaigns, visit [Think BeforeYouPink.org](http://ThinkBeforeYouPink.org).

3. It's "healthy"

Remember when yogurt was just yogurt? Now you have yogurt "for digestive health" and yogurt for "immune defense." There is a growing debate over how much influence these new products will have over your health, and the definitive verdict is that you will only experience benefits if you continue to use them. With a cost of two to three times more than their "regular" counterparts, many people can't make that kind of commitment. Several lawsuits have many experts reminding consumers that yogurt alone isn't the cure for all digestive ailments. While they won't be discouraging yogurt use entirely, it is important to remember that there is no miracle cure for your health.

Additional healthy food trends that will become popular this year include the inclusion of DHA omega-3 into baby food, pomegranate and